



Final paper



Published



Assign To



Edit



Your choice of: creative work, digital artifact (**experimental for both of these: check with me first**), or research paper (**standard choice**) which will develop out of the prospectus and incorporate original research (more to be shared on Canvas). 7 to 10 pages.

Your final paper should describe original research that builds on your prospectus and seeks to answer a question or address an important topic related to the history of drugs. This is an argument-driven assignment, meaning that you should have a clear point of view and a well-defined area of research. Any time period is appropriate. As with the prospectus, your paper should include at least two to five primary sources and at least five secondary sources – this is a **minimum** requirement.

The paper should be **seven to ten pages** (double spaced) in 12-point Times New Font and should have footnoted citations **in Chicago style**, along with an accompanying bibliography at the end. Please submit on Canvas only (no hard copies) and in **PDF format only**. I am not able to grant extensions for this paper due to the time constraints of the quarter, so please schedule your time accordingly.

For information on the Chicago style of citations, see this helpful primer from UCSC's politics department: <https://politics.ucsc.edu/undergraduate/chicago%20style%20guide.pdf> (<https://politics.ucsc.edu/undergraduate/chicago%20style%20guide.pdf>).

I have created a "style sheet" which will give you guidance on the look and feel of your paper: things like the font size, citation style, and helpful tips and solutions to common problems. [Please read it here \(https://canvas.ucsc.edu/courses/85875/pages/style-sheet-for-151b-final-paper\)](https://canvas.ucsc.edu/courses/85875/pages/style-sheet-for-151b-final-paper).

Please feel free to contact me by email (bebreen@ucsc.edu (<mailto:bebreen@ucsc.edu>)) if you have any specific questions about your final paper. I am also happy to read and give feedback on drafts of your paper provided you share them with me **at least one week prior to the due date, which is Wednesday, December 8.**

Good luck!

Complete guidelines and rubric

Your final paper should incorporate original research that builds on your reading over the quarter and seeks to answer a question or address an important topic relating to some aspect of drug history (I am defining drugs intentionally broadly here – “anything consumed to alter mind or body,” including such things as sugar and other foods, as well as medicines, will be appropriate choices). Any time period is acceptable, although if you are writing a paper dealing with very recent history, please be especially mindful of the need to utilize appropriate primary and secondary sources (i.e., no YouTube videos!). Also, be aware that the further you go back in the past, the more difficult it will be to find appropriate sources in English.

Your paper should include **at least two primary sources** and **at least five secondary sources** – this is a **minimum** requirement. You are encouraged to use more than this, especially when it comes to primary sources.

The assignment should be **ten to twelve pages** (double spaced) in 12-point Times New Font and should have **footnoted citations in Chicago style**, along with an accompanying bibliography at the end (note: the bibliography does **not** count toward your page count). It is not necessary to annotate the bibliography. Simple list your sources using Chicago bibliography format. You are allowed to go over the twelve page limit, but I would generally recommend not writing more than fourteen pages. Please check with me if you want to write more.

Please do not include a title page or cover page, and remember to number all pages. Feel free to include as many illustrations as you’d like (referenced in the text as Figure 1, Figure 2, etc), but keep in mind that images do not count toward the overall page count. And finally, **always remember to edit and proofread your work multiple times!**

GRADING SCALE

A	93-100
A-	90-92
B+	88-89
B	82-87
B-	80-82
C+	78-79
C	72-77 (and so on)

A: Excellent – clear statement of your research question, good overview of the topic and effective introductory paragraph and conclusion. Convincing engagement with primary and secondary sources, well written and proof-read.

A- to B+: Very Good – does most of the above tasks well, perhaps with one or two weak points, but overall a convincing argument and clear engagement with sources.

B to B-: Good to Decent – has some well-done elements, but fails to achieve one or two of the major tasks (i.e. no clearly defined topic, weak conclusion or introduction, problems with use of sources).

C+ to C-: Poor – performs few of the tasks successfully.

D+ and lower: Unacceptable – incomplete and/or not a good faith attempt at the assignment.



Grade:	D and F (Did not meet expectations)	C (Partially met expectations)	B (Generally met Expectations)	A (Fully met Expectations)
Choice of topic	No topic chosen, or choice is not relevant	Topic chosen does not adequately address class themes	Topic appropriately addresses class themes	Topic is not only appropriate, but shows a high degree of originality or thoughtfulness
Research	Does not engage with primary sources	Makes some attempt to analyze primary sources	Meets expectations in use of primary sources	Engages in sophisticated analysis of primary sources; typically includes more than the required number
Organization	Needs significant improvement	Structure is of inconsistent quality; may be choppy and/or have redundancies	Structure supports the argument; clearly ordered sections	Structure supports and enhances the argument; thoughtful organization that flows easily
Secondary sources	Draws on no secondary sources	Selected sources inadequate in number and/or inappropriate for investigation of stated problem	Some sources address topic but others are inappropriate; source base overall solid	Sources selected are relevant and well-chosen
Grammar & Clarity	Significantly impairs readability	Frequent or serious errors	Some minor errors	Virtually no errors

Sample paper

I have added a redacted paper which received an "A" grade in a different version of this course as a sample. You can download and read it here:

[Sample paper: Redacted "A" paper from a previous version of History 151B.pdf](https://canvas.ucsc.edu/courses/85875/files/11363532?wrap=1)

(<https://canvas.ucsc.edu/courses/85875/files/11363532?wrap=1>) 

(https://canvas.ucsc.edu/courses/85875/files/11363532/download?download_frd=1)

Points 100